NADIA BRENNAN-AZIZ

Senior Platform Engineer | Cloud Infrastructure & Site Reliability

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior platform and site reliability engineer with 10 years in infrastructure and six years running Kubernetes platforms on AWS. Technical lead for a five-person platform team, experienced in cloud infrastructure and platform design and operation, Terraform, observability, incident management, and self-service infrastructure supporting product teams from service creation through production.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, SQS, Route 53, CloudFront), Kubernetes, Linux, Terraform, Atlantis, Puppet, Karpenter

Platform engineering: Argo CD, Crossplane, Helm, Kustomize, GitHub Actions, Backstage catalog

Observability and reliability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, OpenTelemetry, Sloth, PagerDuty, SLOs and error budgets, incident management, k6

Programming: Go, Python, Bash

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer | Tallybrook Ltd | Apr 2022–Present

- Technical lead for a five-person platform team operating eight EKS clusters across three regions, supporting approximately 350 services.
- Designed and built an internal developer platform using Go and Python service templates, Argo CD GitOps and Crossplane-based self-service for RDS, SQS and S3; adopted by all 14 product teams and reduced time from new service to production from approximately two weeks to under one day.
- Introduced SLOs and burn-rate alerts for 20 critical services and agreed an error-budget policy with product leadership; on-call pages fell by approximately 60%.
- Migrated node provisioning to Karpenter and Spot instances for stateless workloads, including interruption handling; reduced EC2 spend by 38%, approximately £410,000 per year.
- Served in the incident commander rotation and wrote the incident and post-mortem process.
- Mentored three backend engineers into SRE roles.

Site Reliability Engineer | Brightwater Games | Jan 2019–Mar 2022

- Operated AWS infrastructure using EC2, ECS and EKS for game backends serving up to 1.2 million daily active players.
- Managed AWS infrastructure with approximately 40 Terraform modules and used Atlantis for pull-request-based plan and apply workflows.
- Replaced a noisy Nagios setup with Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager and Loki for monitoring and alerting.
- Led capacity planning for two major launches. Used k6 to simulate 300,000 concurrent players and identified and fixed a connection pool limit before launch.

Linux Systems Engineer | Pennine Hosting | Jul 2016–Dec 2018

- Managed approximately 600 Linux servers for hosting customers, using Puppet for configuration management.
- Automated tasks in Bash and Python and provided on-call support for customer incidents.

PROJECTS AND SPEAKING

- Internal Developer Platform, Tallybrook (2022–2024) — Designed golden-path Go and Python service templates, Argo CD ApplicationSets, and Crossplane compositions for RDS, SQS and S3 requested through pull requests; adopted by all 14 product teams.
- Kubernetes cleanup operator, 2024: Built an open-source controller in Go using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces; approximately 120 GitHub stars.
- UK DevOps meetup, 2024: Spoke on “SLOs that product managers care about.”

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science | University of the North Moors | 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | 2021, renewed 2024
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional | 2023

LANGUAGES

English (native) | Urdu (conversational)